

perform but also challenging for an audience to process.

Similar problems were apparent in Berlioz's most celebrated opera, *Les Troyens* (The Trojans, 1856–1858). Its original running time was well over five hours and the many, complex scene changes made it a nightmare to produce. As a result, he was obliged to divide it into two separate operas. The first full staging of the entire work did not take place until a production at Covent Garden in London in 1957.

Berlioz was awarded the Legion of Honor in 1839 and appointed curator of the Conservatoire library, but was passed over for many more important official posts. He was generally held in higher esteem outside France—his concert tours as conductor in England, Germany, and Russia, for example, were a triumph. Berlioz's reputation in his home country grew after his death, aided greatly by the publication of his sparkling *Memoirs* (1865), and he is now revered as one of the nation's greatest Romantic composers.